Name: _____ Period: _____

BE CAREFUL OF YOUR ASSUMPTIONS

Learning Intention: Today we will be learning to tell the difference between evidence and assumptions so we can make conclusions based on information we can support.
Success Criteria:

- I can identify what counts as evidence and what is an assumption.
- I can explain why an assumption may not be supported by evidence.
- I can use evidence instead of assumptions to make a conclusion.

Evidence: information you can directly observe, measure, or verify that supports an idea or conclusion.
Assumption: something you accept as true without enough evidence, often because it seems familiar, expected, or likely.

As you watch the demo, record what you actually observe and what you find yourself assuming.

ASSUMPTIONS (at least 3)	EVIDENCE (at least 2)

Directions: Try to solve the following "mysteries." When you think you have an answer, write it out and justify your reasoning for the solution.

Scenario 1
One night, my aunt was reading a book and was just getting to an exciting part, when a storm knocked out all the electrical power to her house. Aunt Hannah had no matches, candles, flashlight, or any other means of light, but she just kept right on reading until she finished her book. How could she do that?

Reason: _____

_____

Scenario 2
Every day, Mandy rises up out of bed, gets in the elevator in her building and presses the button to take her to the lobby. At the end of the day, when she returns from work, she gets in the elevator and presses the button for the ninth floor. She gets out and walks up 5 floors to her room, even though the elevator would take her to her floor. Why?? (She does NOT do it for exercise.)

Reason: _____

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Scenario 3
The Reverend Terry Fallhard announced that Sunday he would perform a great miracle. He said he would walk on the surface of the Red River without sinking into the water. A large crowd gathered to witness the event. The Reverend did exactly what he said he would. How??

Reason: _____

_____

Scenario 4
Last week, I turned off the light in my bedroom and managed to get to bed before the room was dark. If the bed was 10 feet from the light switch that controls the light, how did I do it??

Reason: _____

_____

Scenario 5
Osgood Farkle of Podunk County has married twenty different women from the same town. All are still living, and he never divorced any of them. Yet he broke no law. Can you explain??

Reason: _____

_____

Scenario 6
"This parrot will repeat any word it hears," said the pet shop owner. A woman bought the bird, but brought it back a week later to complain that the bird had not yet spoken a single word. However, the pet shop owner had told the truth. Explain!

Reason: _____

_____

Exit Ticket:

1. In your *own words*, what's the difference between an evidence and an assumption?

   _____

   _____

2. Pick one mystery from today. What assumption almost tricked you, and what's the evidence that proves it wrong?

   _____

   _____

3. Why does it matter in science to base your conclusions on evidence instead of assumptions?

   _____

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